Heaven's Light is Our Guide

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Lab Report 5-9

Study of Morphological Operations on Image

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1 Experiment 5: Image Thresholding

1.1 Theory and Introduction

Image thresholding is a fundamental method of image segmentation. It is used to convert a grayscale image into a binary image (black and white) by separating objects of interest from the background based on their pixel intensity [1]. A threshold value T is selected, and each pixel is evaluated against this value:

$$g(x, y) = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } f(x, y) \geq T \\ 0, & \text{if } f(x, y) < T \end{cases}$$

This experiment explores the manual implementation of this thresholding logic without relying on built-in binarization functions.

1.2 Methodology

A grayscale matrix was evaluated, and conditional logic was applied pixel-by-pixel to generate the binary output.

1.2.1 Matrix Definition

A 5×5 matrix with an increasing gradient of intensity values (ranging from 10 to 255) was defined to clearly observe the boundary created by the threshold.

$$I = \begin{bmatrix} 10 & 50 & 100 & 150 & 200 \\ 30 & 80 & 120 & 180 & 220 \\ 60 & 110 & 140 & 210 & 250 \\ 90 & 130 & 170 & 230 & 240 \\ 120 & 160 & 190 & 245 & 255 \end{bmatrix}$$

A threshold value of $T = 127$ was selected.

1.2.2 Python Implementation

The implementation avoids built-in thresholding functions. An empty array of zeros was created, and nested loops were utilized to iterate through every coordinate. The intensity value was checked against T, and the corresponding output pixel was set to 1 (or 255 for visualization) or 0.

```python
import numpy as np
import os
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

# 1. Create a 5x5 grayscale matrix image (values 0-255)
img_exp5 = np.array(
    [
        [10, 50, 100, 150, 200],
        [30, 80, 120, 180, 220],
        [60, 110, 140, 210, 250],
        [90, 130, 170, 230, 240],
        [120, 160, 190, 245, 255],
    ],
    dtype=np.uint8,
)

T = 127  # Threshold value

# 2. Manual thresholding using nested loops
bw_img = np.zeros_like(img_exp5)
rows, cols = img_exp5.shape

for i in range(rows):
    for j in range(cols):
        if img_exp5[i, j] >= T:
            bw_img[i, j] = 1  # Or 255 for display purposes
        else:
            bw_img[i, j] = 0

print("--- Experiment 5: Thresholding ---")
print("Original Matrix:\n", img_exp5)
print(f"B&W Matrix (T={T}):\n", bw_img)
```

```python
# Save the image
output_dir = "./images/output"
os.makedirs(output_dir, exist_ok=True)
output_path = os.path.join(output_dir, "lab5.png")
plt.figure(figsize=(8, 4))
plt.subplot(1, 2, 1)
plt.imshow(img_exp5, cmap="gray")
plt.title("Original Image")
plt.subplot(1, 2, 2)
plt.imshow(bw_img, cmap="gray")
plt.title(f"Thresholded (T={T})")
plt.savefig(output_path)
print(f"Image saved to {output_path}")
```

1.3 Results

The code generated a segmented binary matrix, visualized in the figure below.

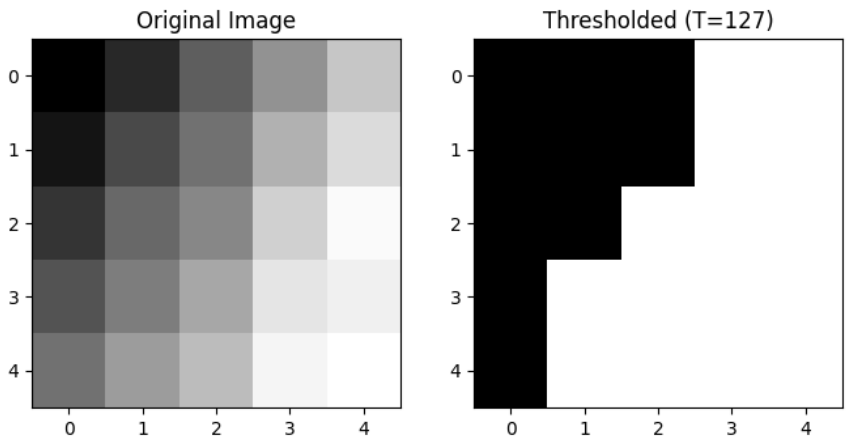

Figure 1: Image Thresholding ($T = 127$). Left: Original grayscale gradient. Right: The resulting binary image showing a clear step-edge segmentation.

1.4 Discussion

The manual conditional mapping successfully segmented the matrix. As observed in the results, all pixels with an intensity ≥ 127 (located towards the bottom right) were assigned the foreground value (white), while those < 127 (top left) were assigned the background value (black). This created a clear diagonal boundary, demonstrating how thresholding groups similar intensity regions.

1.5 Conclusion

The underlying mathematical principle of binary segmentation was validated. By manually applying the threshold piecewise function via iterative loops, it was confirmed that object isolation can be achieved strictly through simple intensity condition checks.

2 Experiment 6: Linear Contrast Stretching

2.1 Theory and Introduction

Linear contrast stretching is a spatial domain enhancement technique used to expand the dynamic range of an image [1]. It employs a piecewise linear transformation function defined by critical points (r_1, s_1) and (r_2, s_2). The transformation is divided into three regions—dark, mid-tone, and bright—each governed by a distinct slope (α, β, γ):

- **Dark region** $(0 \to r_1)$**:** Slope $\alpha = \frac{s_1}{r_1}$
- **Mid-tone region** $(r_1 \to r_2)$**:** Slope $\beta = \frac{s_2 - s_1}{r_2 - r_1}$
- **Bright region** $(r_2 \to L - 1)$**:** Slope $\gamma = \frac{(L-1) - s_2}{(L-1) - r_2}$

2.2 Methodology

The piecewise slopes were calculated, and the transformation was mapped across the pixels of a standard test image (Lenna) to enhance contrast.

2.2.1 Parameter Definition

The input parameters were defined as $r_1 = 70, r_2 = 180$ and target values $s_1 = 40, s_2 = 220$. The maximum intensity level was set to $L - 1 = 255$.

2.2.2 Python Implementation

The slopes α, β, and γ were computed mathematically. Nested loops were used to evaluate each pixel and apply the corresponding linear equation based on which intensity region the pixel occupied.

```python
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import os
from PIL import Image

# 1. Given points
r1, r2 = 70, 180
s1, s2 = 40, 220
L_max = 255

# 2. Calculate slopes (Alpha, Beta, Gamma)
alpha = s1 / r1
beta = (s2 - s1) / (r2 - r1)
gamma = (L_max - s2) / (L_max - r2)

print("\n--- Experiment 6: Contrast Stretching ---")
print(f"Alpha (Dark): {alpha:.2f}")
print(f"Beta (Mid): {beta:.2f}")
print(f"Gamma (Bright): {gamma:.2f}")

# Load Lenna image
img_exp6 = np.array(Image.open("./images/Lenna.png").convert("L"), dtype=np.uint8)
out_exp6 = np.zeros_like(img_exp6, dtype=np.float32)

# 3. Apply piecewise stretching
for i in range(img_exp6.shape[0]):
    for j in range(img_exp6.shape[1]):
        r = img_exp6[i, j]
        if r < r1:
            out_exp6[i, j] = alpha * r
        elif r1 <= r <= r2:
            out_exp6[i, j] = beta * (r - r1) + s1
        else:
            out_exp6[i, j] = gamma * (r - r2) + s2

print("Original min/max:", img_exp6.min(), img_exp6.max())
print("Stretched min/max:", out_exp6.min(), out_exp6.max())

# Save the image
output_dir = "./images/output"
os.makedirs(output_dir, exist_ok=True)
output_path = os.path.join(output_dir, "lab6.png")

plt.figure(figsize=(12, 5))
```

```python
plt.subplot(1, 2, 1)
plt.imshow(img_exp6, cmap="gray")
plt.title("Original Image")
plt.axis("off")
plt.subplot(1, 2, 2)
plt.imshow(np.round(out_exp6).astype(np.uint8), cmap="gray")
plt.title("Stretched Image")
plt.axis("off")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig(output_path, dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
print(f"Image saved to {output_path}")
plt.show()
```

2.3 Results

The transformation stretched the mid-tones while compressing extreme shadows and highlights.

Figure 2: Contrast Stretching Results. Left: Original low-contrast image. Right: Stretched image demonstrating enhanced definition and deeper contrast.

2.4 Discussion

The calculated slopes dictate the visual outcome. A slope of $\beta > 1$ in the mid-tone region ($70 \rightarrow 180$) significantly increased the contrast of the subject's features, stretching a narrow band of input values across a wider output range ($40 \rightarrow 220$). Conversely, the dark and bright regions were compressed ($\alpha < 1, \gamma < 1$), which pushed near-black and near-white pixels closer to the absolute limits without clipping. The visual result is a much crisper image.

2.5 Conclusion

The mechanism of piecewise contrast stretching was successfully implemented. It was demonstrated that by mathematically adjusting the linear slopes mapping input to output intensities, specific tonal ranges can be selectively enhanced or suppressed to improve global image quality.

3 Experiment 7: Morphological Erosion and Dilation

3.1 Theory and Introduction

Morphological image processing relies on non-linear operations related to the shape or morphology of features [1]. The two most fundamental operations are:

- **Erosion:** Shrinks or thins objects in a binary image. It is mathematically equivalent to taking the minimum value within the neighborhood defined by a Structuring Element (SE).
- **Dilation:** Grows or thickens objects in a binary image. It is mathematically equivalent to taking the maximum value within the neighborhood defined by the SE.

3.2 Methodology

Morphological operations were manually applied to a synthetic matrix using sliding window arrays rather than built-in morphological functions.

3.2.1 Matrix Definition

A 7×7 binary image matrix with a centered 5×5 square of 1s was defined. A 3×3 Structuring Element (SE) consisting of all 1s was utilized. Zero-padding was applied to the image borders.

3.2.2 Python Implementation

The image was padded with 0s to accommodate the edges. A nested loop structure was used to extract 3×3 windows. For erosion, `np.min(window)` was applied; for dilation, `np.max(window)` was applied.

```python
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import os
from PIL import Image

# 1. Define Image and Structuring Element (SE)
img_exp7 = np.array(
    [
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
    ],
    dtype=np.uint8,
)

SE = np.ones((3, 3), dtype=np.uint8)


# 2. Manual Erosion (min of window)
def manual_erode(img, se):
    pad = se.shape[0] // 2
    # Padding with 0 as requested in the prompt
    padded = np.pad(img, pad, mode="constant", constant_values=0)
    out = np.zeros_like(img)

    for i in range(img.shape[0]):
        for j in range(img.shape[1]):
            window = padded[i : i + se.shape[0], j : j + se.shape[1]]
            out[i, j] = np.min(window)
    return out


# 3. Manual Dilation (max of window)
def manual_dilate(img, se):
    pad = se.shape[0] // 2
    padded = np.pad(img, pad, mode="constant", constant_values=0)
    out = np.zeros_like(img)

    for i in range(img.shape[0]):
        for j in range(img.shape[1]):
            window = padded[i : i + se.shape[0], j : j + se.shape[1]]
            out[i, j] = np.max(window)
    return out
```

```python
eroded_img = manual_erode(img_exp7, SE)
dilated_img = manual_dilate(img_exp7, SE)

print("\n--- Experiment 7: Morphological Operations ---")
print("Original 7x7:\n", img_exp7)
print("Eroded (Shrinks 1s):\n", eroded_img)
print("Dilated (Expands 1s):\n", dilated_img)

# Save the image
output_dir = "./images/output"
os.makedirs(output_dir, exist_ok=True)
output_path = os.path.join(output_dir, "lab7.png")

plt.figure(figsize=(12, 5))
plt.subplot(1, 3, 1)
plt.imshow(img_exp7, cmap="gray")
plt.title("Original Image")
# Add gridlines
ax1 = plt.gca()
ax1.set_xticks(np.arange(-0.5, img_exp7.shape[1], 1), minor=True)
ax1.set_yticks(np.arange(-0.5, img_exp7.shape[0], 1), minor=True)
ax1.grid(which="minor", color="red", linestyle="-", linewidth=0.5)
plt.subplot(1, 3, 2)
plt.imshow(np.round(dilated_img).astype(np.uint8), cmap="gray")
plt.title("Dilated Image")
# Add gridlines
ax2 = plt.gca()
ax2.set_xticks(np.arange(-0.5, dilated_img.shape[1], 1), minor=True)
ax2.set_yticks(np.arange(-0.5, dilated_img.shape[0], 1), minor=True)
ax2.grid(which="minor", color="red", linestyle="-", linewidth=0.5)
plt.subplot(1, 3, 3)
plt.imshow(np.round(eroded_img).astype(np.uint8), cmap="gray")
plt.title("Eroded Image")
# Add gridlines
ax3 = plt.gca()
ax3.set_xticks(np.arange(-0.5, eroded_img.shape[1], 1), minor=True)
ax3.set_yticks(np.arange(-0.5, eroded_img.shape[0], 1), minor=True)
ax3.grid(which="minor", color="red", linestyle="-", linewidth=0.5)
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig(output_path, dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
print(f"Image saved to {output_path}")
plt.show()
```

3.3 Results

The fundamental shape modifications were recorded in the output matrices.

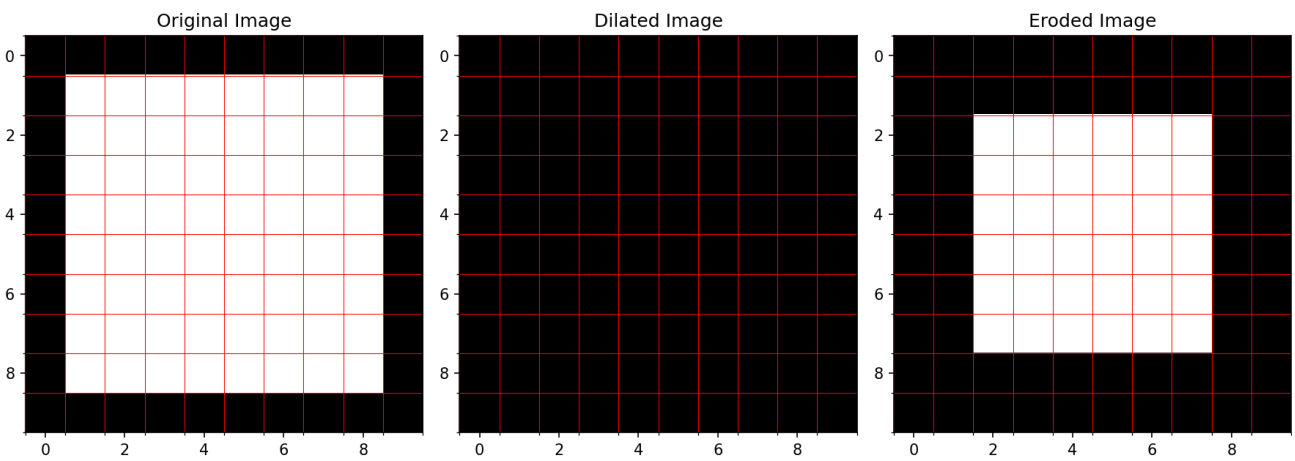

Figure 3: Morphological Basics. The central white shape is reduced via erosion and expanded via dilation (subject to padding constraints).

3.4 Discussion

The sliding window technique directly mirrors morphological theory. During erosion, if even a single zero from the background entered the 3×3 window, the minimum value became 0, effectively stripping the outermost layer of 1s from the square shape. Conversely, during dilation, the presence of a single 1

inside the window forced the center pixel to 1, causing the shape boundaries to expand outward.

3.5 Conclusion

The theoretical concepts of morphological erosion and dilation were verified through manual implementation. It was established that non-linear min and max filters combined with a structuring element effectively manipulate the boundaries of binary objects.

4 Experiment 8: Morphological Opening and Closing

4.1 Theory and Introduction

Opening and closing are secondary morphological operations constructed by combining erosion and dilation in specific sequences [1].

- **Opening ($A \circ B$):** Erosion followed by dilation. It smooths the contour of an object, breaks narrow isthmuses, and eliminates thin protrusions (noise).
- **Closing ($A \bullet B$):** Dilation followed by erosion. It smooths sections of contours, fuses narrow breaks and long thin gulfs, and fills small holes in the object.

4.2 Methodology

A binary image containing geometric artifacts (narrow bridges and gaps) was defined to test both operations using the previously developed erosion and dilation functions.

4.2.1 Matrix Definition

A customized binary matrix was structured to exhibit two large rectangular blocks connected by a narrow horizontal bridge, demonstrating vulnerabilities susceptible to opening and closing.

4.2.2 Python Implementation

The logic was executed sequentially. The `manual_open()` function routed the output of `manual_erode()` directly into `manual_dilate()`. The `manual_close()` function inverted this sequence.

```python
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import os
from PIL import Image

# Define the structuring element
SE = np.ones((3, 3), dtype=np.uint8)


# 2. Manual Erosion (min of window)
def manual_erode(img, se):
    pad = se.shape[0] // 2
    # Padding with 0 as requested in the prompt
    padded = np.pad(img, pad, mode="constant", constant_values=0)
    out = np.zeros_like(img)

    for i in range(img.shape[0]):
        for j in range(img.shape[1]):
            window = padded[i : i + se.shape[0], j : j + se.shape[1]]
            out[i, j] = np.min(window)
    return out


# 3. Manual Dilation (max of window)
def manual_dilate(img, se):
    pad = se.shape[0] // 2
    padded = np.pad(img, pad, mode="constant", constant_values=0)
    out = np.zeros_like(img)

    for i in range(img.shape[0]):
        for j in range(img.shape[1]):
            window = padded[i : i + se.shape[0], j : j + se.shape[1]]
            out[i, j] = np.max(window)
    return out


# 1. Define Opening and Closing functions using Exp 7 definitions
def manual_open(img, se):
    # Opening = Erode -> Dilate
    return manual_dilate(manual_erode(img, se), se)


def manual_close(img, se):
    # Closing = Dilate -> Erode
    return manual_erode(manual_dilate(img, se), se)


# We use an image with noise to show the effect
img_exp8 = np.array(
```

```python
    [
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 1, 1, 1, 0],
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
    ],
    dtype=np.uint8,
)


opened_img = manual_open(img_exp8, SE)
closed_img = manual_close(img_exp8, SE)

print("\n--- Experiment 8: Opening & Closing ---")
print("Original Image (with sticking out noise):\n", img_exp8)
print("Opened Image (Removes noise):\n", opened_img)
print("Closed Image (Fills holes):\n", closed_img)
# Save the image
output_dir = "./images/output"
os.makedirs(output_dir, exist_ok=True)
output_path = os.path.join(output_dir, "lab8.png")

plt.figure(figsize=(12, 5))
plt.subplot(1, 3, 1)
plt.imshow(img_exp8, cmap="gray")
plt.title("Original Image")
# Add gridlines
ax1 = plt.gca()
ax1.set_xticks(np.arange(-0.5, img_exp8.shape[1], 1), minor=True)
ax1.set_yticks(np.arange(-0.5, img_exp8.shape[0], 1), minor=True)
ax1.grid(which="minor", color="red", linestyle="-", linewidth=0.5)
plt.subplot(1, 3, 2)
plt.imshow(opened_img, cmap="gray")
plt.title("Opened Image")
# Add gridlines
ax2 = plt.gca()
ax2.set_xticks(np.arange(-0.5, opened_img.shape[1], 1), minor=True)
ax2.set_yticks(np.arange(-0.5, opened_img.shape[0], 1), minor=True)
ax2.grid(which="minor", color="red", linestyle="-", linewidth=0.5)
plt.subplot(1, 3, 3)
plt.imshow(closed_img, cmap="gray")
plt.title("Closed Image")
# Add gridlines
ax3 = plt.gca()
ax3.set_xticks(np.arange(-0.5, closed_img.shape[1], 1), minor=True)
ax3.set_yticks(np.arange(-0.5, closed_img.shape[0], 1), minor=True)
ax3.grid(which="minor", color="red", linestyle="-", linewidth=0.5)
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig(output_path, dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
print(f"Image saved to {output_path}")
plt.show()
```

4.3 Results

The geometric structures were fundamentally altered based on the operation sequence.

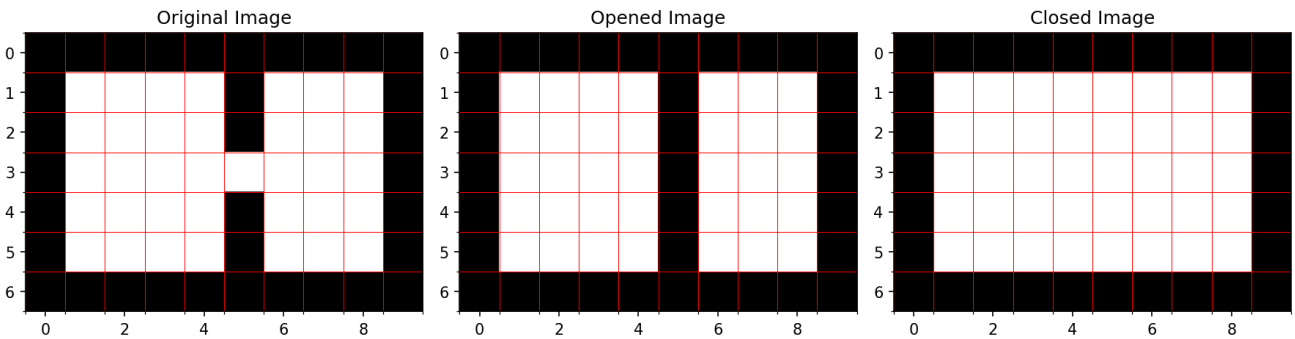

Figure 4: Opening and Closing. Left: Original shape with a bridge. Center: Opened image (bridge broken). Right: Closed image (bridge expanded and holes filled).

4.4 Discussion

The sequence of operations dictated the morphological outcome. In the Opening operation, the initial erosion completely obliterated the narrow bridge because the structuring element could not fit inside it. The subsequent dilation restored the primary blocks to their original size, but the bridge remained permanently erased. In the Closing operation, the initial dilation expanded the shapes, merging them across the gap. The subsequent erosion brought the outer boundaries back to normal, but the merged gap remained filled.

4.5 Conclusion

The utility of compound morphological operations was successfully demonstrated. It was verified that Opening is an effective tool for separating loosely connected objects and removing noise, while Closing is highly effective at fusing breaks and filling internal voids within objects.

5 Experiment 9: Hit-or-Miss Transform

5.1 Theory and Introduction

The Hit-or-Miss Transform (HMT) is a basic morphological tool used for shape detection and pattern recognition within binary images. It utilizes a composite structuring element containing two parts: B_1 to detect the foreground shape (the "hit"), and B_2 to detect the local background (the "miss") [1].

$$A \circledast B = (A \ominus B_1) \cap (A^c \ominus B_2)$$

A pixel is set to 1 in the output only if the foreground SE perfectly matches the image foreground, and the background SE perfectly matches the image background.

5.2 Methodology

A region of interest (ROI) was cropped from a larger image, and two specific structuring elements were configured to isolate a particular geometric pattern.

5.2.1 Matrix Definition

A region of interest was defined containing various noise elements and a few precise 2×2 square patterns. SE_1 was defined as a 2×2 matrix of 1s (to detect the square), while SE_2 was defined as the surrounding background elements (0s) necessary to ensure isolation.

5.2.2 Python Implementation

The SciPy `binary_hit_or_miss` function (equivalent to MATLAB's `bwhitmiss`) was utilized. The algorithm simultaneously applies erosion using SE_1 on the image and SE_2 on the complement of the image, returning the logical AND of the results.

```python
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import os
from scipy.ndimage import binary_hit_or_miss

print("\n--- Experiment 9: Hit-or-Miss Transform ---")

# 1. Define image
img_full = np.array(
    [
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 0, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 0, 0],
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0],
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 0, 0, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 0],
        [0, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
        [0, 0, 1, 0, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0],
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0],
        [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0],
    ]
)

# 2. Define structuring elements
# SE1: pattern to find (2x2 square of 1s)
SE1 = np.array([[1, 1], [1, 1]])

# SE2: background around the pattern
SE2 = np.array([[0, 0], [0, 0]])

# 3. Apply Hit-or-Miss
hmt_result = binary_hit_or_miss(img_full, structure1=SE1, structure2=SE2).astype(int)

print("Hit-or-Miss Result (1 indicates pattern found):\n", hmt_result)

# 4. Visualize
output_dir = "./images/output"
os.makedirs(output_dir, exist_ok=True)
output_path = os.path.join(output_dir, "lab9.png")

plt.figure(figsize=(10, 4))
plt.subplot(1, 2, 1)
plt.imshow(img_full, cmap="gray")
plt.title("Original Image")
# Add gridlines
ax1 = plt.gca()
ax1.set_xticks(np.arange(-0.5, img_full.shape[1], 1), minor=True)
```

```python
ax1.set_yticks(np.arange(-0.5, img_full.shape[0], 1), minor=True)
ax1.grid(which="minor", color="red", linestyle="-", linewidth=0.5)
plt.subplot(1, 2, 2)
plt.imshow(hmt_result, cmap="gray")
plt.title("Hit-or-Miss Result")
# Add gridlines
ax2 = plt.gca()
ax2.set_xticks(np.arange(-0.5, hmt_result.shape[1], 1), minor=True)
ax2.set_yticks(np.arange(-0.5, hmt_result.shape[0], 1), minor=True)
ax2.grid(which="minor", color="red", linestyle="-", linewidth=0.5)
plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig(output_path, dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
print(f"Image saved to {output_path}")
plt.show()
```

5.3 Results

The transform successfully isolated the exact locations of the requested geometric patterns.

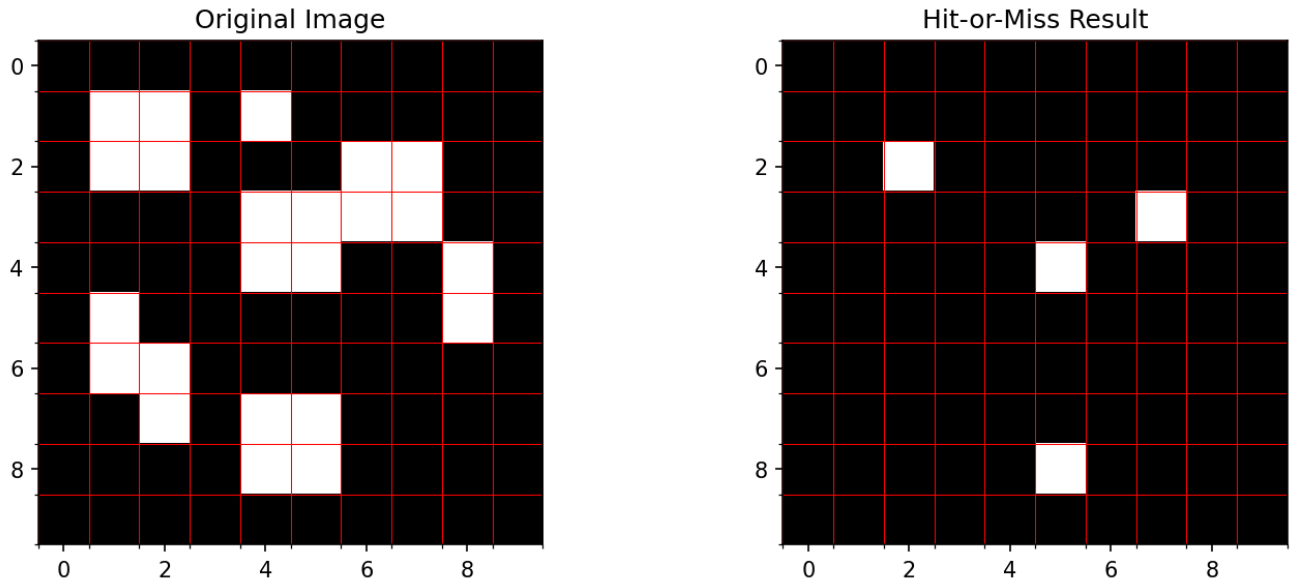

Figure 5: Hit-or-Miss Transform. Left: The original noisy matrix containing various shapes. Right: The single coordinates (hits) where the target 2×2 pattern was perfectly isolated.

5.4 Discussion

The stringent matching criteria of the HMT were clearly demonstrated. The transform ignored 2×3 rectangles and isolated 1s because they failed either the "hit" condition (foreground mismatch) or the "miss" condition (background mismatch). A positive result was only returned at the anchor point where the specific arrangement of 1s and surrounding 0s strictly matched the combined constraints of SE_1 and SE_2.

5.5 Conclusion

The Hit-or-Miss transform was validated as an extremely precise tool for structural analysis. It was shown that by carefully defining both the foreground and background structuring elements, specific patterns and features can be localized within complex binary images.

References

[1] R. C. Gonzalez and R. E. Woods, *Digital Image Processing*, 4th ed. Boston, MA, USA: Pearson, 2018.